LAWD's Growth on Autopilot: Slashing Onboarding Management Time by 50%

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

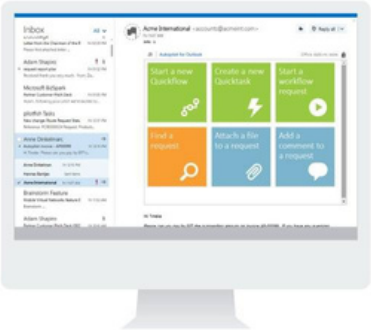
LAWD, a leading property advisory firm in Australia, faced challenges managing its rapid staff expansion. With no internal HR or IT department, their manual onboarding processes led to delays and difficulty keeping track of which stages had been completed. By implementing Autopilot, LAWD was able to save 40%-50% of the time previously spent on recruitment and contract onboarding processes. Autopilot's built-in audit-trail feature has also significantly improved onboarding task accountability.
This transformation has enabled LAWD to scale its operations more effectively, supporting continued growth while hiring a new staff member every week.
"We used to use a mental checklist, so you can imagine that a few things fell through the cracks. Now, when things go wrong, we can refer back to the onboarding tool, and we know exactly what happened." - Jo Beamsley, National Operations Manager @ LAWD

CLIENT OVERVIEW

LAWD is a leading firm specializing in property advisory, transaction, and valuation services across Australia, with a particular focus on land, agribusiness, and development sectors. Founded in 2020, the company has rapidly expanded to more than 100 staff members, operating across the country. This growth necessitated a more efficient and scalable onboarding process to ensure that new employees had quick and easy access to the resources they needed to be productive.

CHALLENGES

Overcome the hassles and challenges of manually managing productivity and collaboration from your inbox.



Rapid Expansion Without HR Support

LAWD's staff count doubled from 50 to over 100 in a short span of time, but the company lacked an internal HR department. This meant that the National Operations Manager and CEO were managing recruitment and onboarding tasks, causing bottlenecks.

Manual Processes Leading to Errors

Onboarding was managed manually through email and informal mental checklists, which often resulted in missed steps and errors—especially in areas like IT setup for new employees. This caused delays and inconsistent employee experiences.

No Internal IT Department

LAWD relied on a managed service provider for IT needs. With new hires requiring specific IT setups, manual communication often resulted in missing requests or errors during the process, further delaying employee productivity.

SOLUTION

Automated Workflows for Onboarding

Autopilot introduced a fully customized onboarding solution that automated the submission and approval of onboarding tasks. These workflows included key tasks like setting up IT accounts and tracking progress, significantly reducing human error.

Centralized Tracking and Accountability

With Autopilot, LAWD now has a central platform where they can track the entire onboarding process. This has proven useful in troubleshooting IT setup issues, as the system allows the team to refer back to the original request and identify where mistakes occurred.

Flexibility to Adapt to Growth

As LAWD continues to grow and expand into new sectors, the Autopilot onboarding system has been flexible enough to adapt to new business lines and requirements. Regular updates to the workflow are easily implemented, allowing LAWD to remain agile.

FEATURES OF AUTOPILOT USED

Customized Onboarding Workflow

Automates tasks such as assigning IT setups, payroll entries, and equipment provisioning (e.g., laptops with specific software).

Centralized Task Assignment

A unified workflow system assigns tasks to responsible departments (HR, IT, Payroll) and external vendors.

Pre-populated Forms

Pre-filled data forms (e.g., for payroll and IT setups) to reduce manual input errors and streamline information capture.

Approval Workflows

Multiple approval steps are built into the workflow, including reviews by the CEO, Finance, and Payroll departments.

External Task Integration

Allows external teams (e.g., outsourced IT, payroll) to engage with the onboarding process via automated forms seamlessly.

Digital Contract Management

Contracts are generated, uploaded, reviewed, and signed digitally within the system.

Audit Trails and Reporting

A detailed audit trail captures every step of the onboarding process, ensuring transparency and accountability.

Automated Survey Triggers

Autopilot automatically triggers 1-month, 3-month, and 6-month follow-up surveys to new employees, collecting feedback on the onboarding experience.

RESULTS

40%+ Reduction in Time Spent on Onboarding

Jo Beamsley, the Operations Manager at LAWD, estimates that the onboarding process is now **40% faster,** with specific aspects, such as contract management, showing up to **50% time savings.**

Improved Process Visibility and Accountability

Autopilot's system allows LAWD to quickly identify issues and hold the right parties accountable, particularly with IT setup errors. This has improved both internal processes and communication with external service providers.

Increased Scalability and Adaptability

With LAWD's business continuing to grow, the Autopilot onboarding system has scaled efficiently and accommodated the company's evolving needs.

Enhanced Employee Experience

Jo reports that feedback from new hires has been more positive since Autopilot was introduced, with fewer onboarding delays and smoother integration into the company. Pulse surveys have shown positive feedback from new employees during and after onboarding.

CONCLUSION

Autopilot has successfully transformed the onboarding process at LAWD, allowing the company to manage its rapid growth more effectively while saving time and reducing errors. By automating key processes and introducing greater accountability, LAWD is now better positioned to handle future expansions.
This case study highlights how businesses experiencing rapid growth can benefit from implementing workflow automation solutions like Autopilot to streamline critical HR processes.
"We used to use a mental checklist, so you can imagine that a few things fell through the cracks. Now, when things go wrong, we can refer back to the onboarding tool, and we know exactly what happened." - Joanne Beamsley, LAWD

Businesses experiencing rapid growth can benefit from implementing Autopilot's workflow automation solutions to streamline critical HR processes.

For more information or to request a demonstration, contact us at **adam@autopilot.co.za**